

Product Overview

CRED is an Indian fintech app launched in 2018 by Kunal Shah. It rewards credit card users for paying their bills on time. Users earn CRED coins for each payment, redeemable for deals, cashback and products from partner brands. Access requires a credit score above 750, making it a deliberately exclusive, premium-positioned product targeting India's creditworthy urban population.

Target Users

Primary User: Urban Indian professional, 25–40 years old, holds one or more credit cards, earns ₹8L+ annually. Values rewards and convenience. Financially disciplined and digitally active. Secondary User: Young professional, 22–27, recently received their first credit card. Attracted by the rewards structure and wants to build good credit habits.

Problem Being Solved

Credit card bill payment in India has low discipline — many users pay late or pay only the minimum, incurring heavy interest. CRED makes on-time payment feel rewarding rather than obligatory. The deeper business problem CRED solves for itself: it acquires a verified, high-income, creditworthy user base that premium brands and lenders are willing to pay to reach. Every CRED user is pre-screened by their credit score — something no other platform in India offers advertisers at this scale.

Core Features

Feature	What it does
Bill Payment	Pay any credit card bill directly through the app
CRED Coins	Reward points earned per ₹1 paid on time
CRED Store	Redeem coins for products and deals from partners
CRED Travel	Book flights and hotels with member

	discounts
CRED Cash	Instant personal loans to creditworthy members
CRED Mint	P2P lending — earn interest by lending to others
CRED Money	Analyse spending across all linked bank accounts
Refer and Earn	Share a link via WhatsApp, earn cashback when friend signs up and pays first bill

How CRED Makes Money

CRED does not charge users. It monetises through three streams:

1. Brand partnerships: Brands pay to be featured in the Store and Rewards sections, accessing CRED's verified premium users
2. Lending products: CRED Cash and CRED Mint generate interest income
3. Travel and commerce: CRED Travel earns booking commissions

Key Metrics CRED Would Track

- Monthly Active Users (MAU)
- Bill payment volume (₹ total processed per month)
- Coin earn and redemption rate
- Loan disbursement volume and default rate
- Partner brand click-through and conversion rate
- 90-day user retention
- Referral conversion rate (invites sent vs accounts created)
- Net Promoter Score (NPS)

Product Gaps and Opportunities

1. Referral program is underdeveloped: a basic Refer and Earn feature exists but offers limited visibility into the full referral journey. Users cannot see whether their referred friend has signed up or completed a payment after sharing the link. Referral links expire within 48 hours with no reminder, causing users to miss rewards without realising it. The program also runs as an

occasional seasonal campaign rather than a permanent always-on feature, limiting its effectiveness as a growth channel.

2. No credit score improvement roadmap: CRED fetches your credit score on signup but offers no personalised guidance on how to improve it — a clear unmet need for users who want to go from 750 to 800+.

3. Reward relevance: coin redemption options often feature obscure partner brands that are irrelevant to most users, reducing perceived coin value over time.

4. No customer support visibility: users reporting failed payments or order issues have no in-app ticket tracker showing resolution status or estimated timelines.

Mini PRD: CRED Referral Hub

Feature proposal to replace CRED's existing basic referral flow with a structured, trackable, always-on referral experience.

Problem Statement

CRED's current referral program allows users to share a link via WhatsApp, SMS, or email and earn cashback when a friend signs up and pays their first bill. However, the experience provides limited visibility after the link is shared. Users have limited visibility into whether a referred friend has created an account or completed a payment. Referral links expire within 48 hours with no warning, causing users to miss rewards without realising it. The program also runs as an occasional seasonal campaign rather than a permanent feature, meaning users cannot rely on it being available when they want to refer someone. This underutilises CRED's most cost-effective acquisition channel — existing satisfied members who can refer friends with similarly high credit scores.

Goals and Success Metrics

Goal	Metric	Target
Get more new users joining CRED through referrals	Number of new signups coming from referral links per month	+25% within 3 months of launch
Get existing users to actively discover and use the Referral Hub by sending at least one referral	% of monthly active users who send at least one referral per month	20% of MAU within 2 months of launch
Ensure users who reach a milestone reward actually claim it — confirming the reward system is visible and working	% of users who reached a milestone and claimed their reward within 7 days	80% claim rate within 7 days of milestone being reached
Make users return to the Referral Hub after sending a link to check their referral status	% of users who sent a referral and returned to check status within 7 days	50% of referrers check status at least once after sending

User Personas

Persona 1 — Rahul, 31, Product Manager, Bangalore

Rahul has used CRED for 2 years and genuinely likes the app. He has referred 3 friends via WhatsApp but only knows one actually signed up because that friend told him personally. He has no idea what happened with the other two. He does not want to follow up awkwardly. He would refer more people actively if he could track status silently inside the app without involving the friend in the conversation.

Persona 2 — Sneha, 27, Consultant, Mumbai

Sneha referred two friends last month by sharing a WhatsApp link. She has no idea whether either of them opened the link, downloaded the app, or signed up. She does not want to awkwardly follow up with her friends directly to ask. She would actively refer more people if she could quietly track status without having to ask her friends personally.

User Stories

1. As a CRED member, I want to see a Referral Hub page showing all my referrals and their current status — signed up, first payment done, reward credited — so I know exactly where each referral stands without asking my friend directly.
2. As a member, I want to resend or copy my referral link directly from the Referral Hub dashboard so I can follow up with a specific friend without navigating away from the tracking page.
3. As a member, I want to receive a notification when my referred friend has successfully signed up and completed their first payment so I know my referral was successful and my reward is on its way — without having to open the app to check manually.
4. As a member, I want my referral link to always be active and never expire so I can share it at any time without time pressure.
5. As a member, I want to see a milestone tracker showing how many successful referrals I have made and what reward I unlock at the next milestone so I feel motivated to keep referring.
6. As a new user who joined through a referral link, I want a personalised welcome screen explaining what CRED is and what I receive for signing up so I understand the value before I commit.
7. As a member, I want to see my total cashback earned from all referrals in one place so I can see the cumulative value of my participation in the program.

Out of Scope

- Leaderboard showing top referrers across all CRED members
- Accessing contacts list to suggest who to invite
- Automated SMS or email sent on behalf of the user without their action
- Referral program for CRED's lending or travel products — bill payment referrals only

Open Questions

1. Should referral links be permanent or reset monthly to align with changing reward amounts per campaign? This affects how the link generation system is built.
2. If a referred friend does not qualify due to a credit score below 750, how do we notify the referrer without revealing the friend's credit score? Likely a neutral message such as "your friend was unable to join at this time" with no further detail — but this needs to be confirmed with the legal and privacy team.
3. Should milestone rewards be CRED coins, direct cashback, or user's choice? Coins are cheaper for CRED but cashback is more motivating for users — this is a business decision needed before the reward system is built.
4. What fraud prevention mechanism is needed to detect users creating fake accounts to collect referral cashback repeatedly? Engineering needs this defined before building the reward disbursement logic.